

Harpo special exercise: contributions

Each Maso content page has three frames. You can resize them. The top one contains a short list of topics. The middle one has a few multiple choice questions related to those topics. The bottom frame is for your input, either contributions, votes on them, or just question/comments. This page will explain the contributions and will mention the votes and questions again only in the end, before "history". (Note: the very first Maso page (id=700) is for your mandatory self-evaluation but uses the same format as the questions/comments.)

Log in to Harpo and then you can insert the text and reference of your contribution. The teacher will be notified of each insertion, and he will either approve or disapprove it. Before this, the text shows green. An approved text is black, and a disapproved one is light gray (either its text, or in case of clearly a "private" note, the background is gray.)

From the fourth approved contribution onwards each will bring you 1/6 grade points, until the 15th fills your quota from this exercise, 2 points.

The main criterion for approval is that the text is instructive for other students of this course. This means several things. **The text must**

- help the reader to understand a concept or a question on the page. So, one topic suffices, but merely an answer to the question does not count (the answers are actually given).
- stay focused to the topic. If you copy text from elsewhere, edit it so that nothing extra remains. Such editing is not only pruning words, but changing the text to an independent text passage.
- not be just a link to Wikipedia or elsewhere. A link must be accompanied by an explanation.
- not repeat what others have written.
- not mess up the frame. You can use html formatting tags, but be modest. And do not try anything "special", because that would lead to more than disapproval: Embedding images and scripts is disabled but there would certainly be other ways to cause harm to other users. If you cannot tidy up by editing, contact the teacher.

You must use **references**, most naturally by including web links (and Wikipedia is not a bad target). That happens with html in this way: `<a href="https://www.tuni.fi">TAU</a>`. The program adds `target="_blank"` so that the frame is not cluttered. Other kinds of references are also welcome (but not "AI"). For instance the CyBOK text can be referred to in this way: [CyBOK p. 123] or [CyBOK sec. 12.3.4], where p. means the page and sec. the section. If you study with Paul van Oorschot's book, you can write [PvO p.123]. Of course you can also refer to [M&L p.12], meaning Maps & Lists page 12. If you use a direct quote, **use** also quotation marks ("...") and please **add** some of your own words as well.

You should edit a disapproved text to submit it again for approval. The teacher may or may not have edited a comment into your text (but hardly ever to the notes deemed "private"). Keep that comment unless you change your text to something that is not related to the comment any more. While you learn more you are encouraged to edit also your approved texts. This will zero the approval, but as you were improving your contribution, a new approval will soon follow.

Depending on the teacher's judgement an approval on a page will transform **page statuses** of all students, but only from *"Worked on it probably enough..."* to *"Started working ..."* (this appears as an added underline to a green link text).

History

This exercise was new in 2022, and it was not clear how it was going to be used by students. Several possibilities were anticipated and suggested here. Creation of some *learning material* was realized, but not much *discussion* with teacher comments. And the imagined situation of having a collection of *learning diaries* did not come true, even if that was encouraged by suggesting that "you can find a learning diary so useful that you go beyond the 15 entries". Two students did go beyond 20, but it is not clear whether they mainly wanted to be on top of the leaderboard.

Editing and use of AI. A lot of iterative discussion was needed for some students to improve the quality of their texts. And still it seems to many that the contributions are taken from sources without much elaboration. In 2023 this became especially true, because the AI can directly give nice-looking and mostly valid "contributions". It was OK to use AI then, but later it turned out that not enough human care was taken that the generated texts made optimal sense. Even in defining C, I and A on the first and very simple Maso page (id=701) it would be good for both the writer and any reader to use their own critical thinking. This is what the contribution on that page (by ChatGPT) said about "A":

Availability

Goal: Ensure reliable access to data and services.

Methods: Redundancy, failover systems, regular backups.

Importance: Maintains operational continuity and prevents downtime.

Questions you should have asked when submitting contributions are like this: At what level are these definitions? Are they covering, consistent, organized etc. The first method for availability is redundancy and it covers the other two: failover systems and regular backups. What else does 'importance' tell than the 'goal'?

From 2025 on, AI use for contributions, among other things, was strongly restricted by a set of rules. Also, the page "701" was the first "playing ground" for so many students that from 2025 onwards those very general topics were excluded from contributions — not technically but with a prohibition on that Maso page.

Community feedback. Since 2023 the contributions have **vote buttons** ("light bulbs"). They will not affect the ordering or scoring, but please use them to give feedback (anonymous) to the writers and to other readers. It will also give some hint to the teacher whether the contributions actually work as learning material. It is possible that they are just WOM, write-only-material.

Less than contribution. Since 2023 there is also another type of input available: **question/comment**. It is intended to encourage discussion, mainly not with teacher comments but with other students. It should have an even lower writing threshold than the contributions. Maybe the comments can become your learning diary.